Write Hebrew by hand: cursive words

Israelis write by hand in **ktav yad** (cursive), which looks different from the printed letters you read. This workbook gives every one of the 27 letter forms (22 letters and 5 final forms) a handwriting row and up to three real words to copy, in alphabet order.

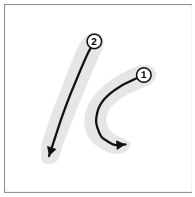
How to use it

1. Look at the stroke box: the numbered circle is where a stroke starts, the arrowhead where it ends.
2. Trace the letter row from the **right**: solid, then grey, then dotted, then write it alone.
3. Each word row shows the pointed printed word (how you read it), its sound and meaning, then the handwritten word to trace. Handwriting is usually written **without** vowel signs, so the traced word has none.
4. Tick the box when you can write the word without looking.

DRAFT: cursive stroke order not reviewed by a native writer; words from the course data, not teacher-checked. Cursive shapes come from the font Gveret Levin (SIL OFL 1.1); real handwriting joins and varies. Words marked * have a machine-made transliteration (Israeli, siddur style) that no native speaker has checked. Every letter form has at least one word.

Contents

1. Alef (3) · 2. Bet (3) · 3. Gimel (3) · 4. Dalet (3) · 5. He (3) · 6. Vav (3) · 7. Zayin (3) · 8. Chet (3) · 9. Tet (3) · 10. Yod (3) · 11. Kaf (3) · 12. Lamed (3) · 13. Mem (3) · 14. Nun (3) · 15. Samekh (3) · 16. Ayin (3) · 17. Pe (3) · 18. Tsadi (3) · 19. Qof (3) · 20. Resh (3) · 21. Shin (3) · 22. Tav (3) · 23. Kaf sofit (3) · 24. Mem sofit (3) · 25. Nun sofit (3) · 26. Pe sofit (3) · 27. Tsadi sofit (3)



א א

1. Alef · silent / a tiny glottal stop, like the pause in 'uh-oh' /ʔ/

2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /ʔ/

☐ 1 אַבָּא *aba** · dad

☐ 2 אִמָּא *ima** · mom

☐ 3 אוֹר *or** · light



ב ב

2. Bet · b with a dot (bet), v without (vet) /b ~ v/

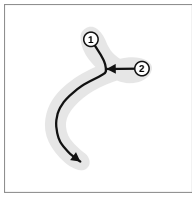
1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /b ~ v/

☐ 1 בֵּית *beit** · house of

☐ 2 בַּבַּיִת *babayit** · in the house

☐ 3 בֶּאֱמֶת *be'emet?* · really?



ג ג

3. Gimel · g as in go /g/

2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /g/

ג ג ג ג ג ג ג ג ג ג ג ג

☐ **1** גַּן *gan** · garden

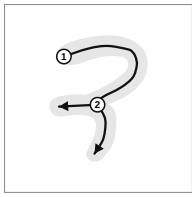
גן גן גן

☐ **2** גַּנָּב *ganav** · thief

גנב גנב גנב

☐ **3** גַּל *gal** · wave

גל גל גל



ד ד

4. Dalet · d as in door /d/

2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /d/

ד ד ד ד ד ד ד ד ד ד ד ד

☐ **1** דֶּלֶת *delet** · door

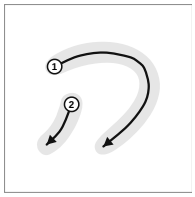
דלת דלת דלת

☐ **2** דַּי *dai* · enough / stop it

די די די

☐ **3** דָּם *dam** · blood

דם דם דם



ה ה

5. He · h as in hat /h/

2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /h/

ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה

☐ **1** הַיּוֹם *hayom* · today

היום היום היום

☐ **2** הַר *har** · mountain

הר הר הר

☐ **3** הֵי *hey* · hi

הי הי הי



ו ו

6. Vav · v as in van /v/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /v/

ו ו

☐ **1** וָואלָה *wallah* · really? / wow / honestly

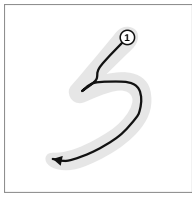
וואלה וואלה וואלה

☐ **2** וָעַד *va'ed** · and ever

ועד ועד ועד

☐ **3** וְאֲנִי *ve'ani** · and I

ואני ואני ואני



ז ז

7. Zayin · z as in zoo /z/

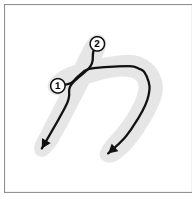
1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /z/

☐ 1 זָהָב *zahav** · gold

☐ 2 זֶה *zeh** · this

☐ 3 זוֹל *zol** · cheap



ח ח

8. Chet · throaty ch, like Bach /χ/

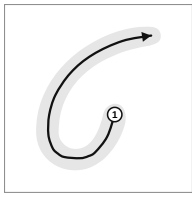
2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /χ/

☐ 1 חָלָב *chalav** · milk

☐ 2 חֵצִי *chetsi* · half

☐ 3 חָבֵר *chaver* · friend



ט ט

9. Tet · t as in top /t/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /t/

ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט

☐ **1** טוֹב *tov* · OK / well / good

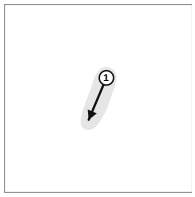
טוב טוב טוב

☐ **2** טֹבוּ *tovu** · good are

טבו טבו טבו

☐ **3** טִיּוּל *tiyul** · trip, hike

טיול טיול טיול



י י

10. Yod · y as in yes /j/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /j/

י י י י י י י י י י י י י י

☐ **1** יָמִינָה *yamina* · right

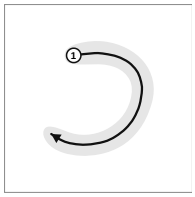
ימינה ימינה ימינה

☐ **2** יָם *yam** · sea

ים ים ים

☐ **3** יָמֵינוּ *yameinu** · our days

ימינו ימינו ימינו



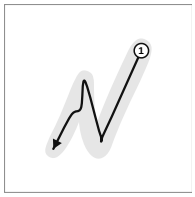
כ כ

11. Kaf · k with a dot (kaf), throaty ch without (khaf) /k ~ χ/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /k ~ χ/

כ כ כ



מ מ

13. Mem · m as in map /m/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /m/

☐ **1** מַיִם *mayim* · water

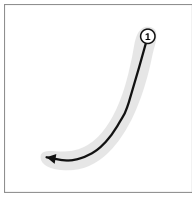
מים מים מים

☐ **2** מֶלֶךְ *melekh** · king

מלך מלך מלך

☐ **3** מִשְׁפָּחָה *mishpachah** · family

משפחה משפחה משפחה



נ נ

14. Nun · n as in net /n/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /n/

☐ **1** נֵר *ner** · candle, lamp

נר נר נר

☐ **2** נֶשֶׁק *neshek** · weapon

נשק נשק נשק

☐ **3** נֵרוֹת *nerot** · candles

נרות נרות נרות



ס ס

15. Samekh · s as in sun /s/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /s/

ס ס ס ס ס ס ס ס ס ס ס ס

☐ **1** סָלָט *salat* · salad

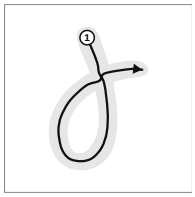
סלט סלט סלט

☐ **2** סֵפֶר *sefer** · book

ספר ספר ספר

☐ **3** סִדּוּר *sidur** · prayer book

סדור סדור סדור



ע ע

16. Ayin · silent in modern Israeli Hebrew (like alef) /ʔ/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /ʔ/

ע ע ע ע ע ע ע ע ע ע ע ע

☐ **1** עֶזְרָה *ezra!* · help!

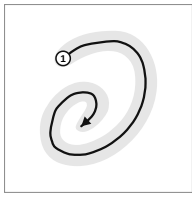
עזרה עזרה עזרה

☐ **2** עֲשָׂרָה *asara* · ten (10)

עשרה עשרה עשרה

☐ **3** עֶשְׂרִים *esrim* · twenty (20)

עשרים עשרים עשרים



פ ף

17. Pe · p with a dot (pe), f without (fe) /p ~ f/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /p ~ f/

ף ף ף ף ף ף ף ף ף ף ף ף

☐ **1** פִּיתָה *pita* · pita bread

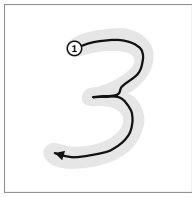
פיתה פיתה פיתה

☐ **2** פָּתוּחַ *patuach* · open

פתוח פתוח פתוח

☐ **3** פָּלָאפֶל *falafel* · falafel

פלאפל פלאפל פלאפל



צ ץ

18. Tsadi · ts as in cats /ts/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /ts/

ץ ץ ץ ץ ץ ץ ץ ץ ץ ץ ץ ץ

☐ **1** צֶדֶק *tzedek** · justice

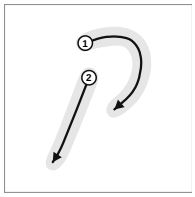
צדק צדק צדק

☐ **2** צָבָא *tzava** · army

צבא צבא צבא

☐ **3** צוֹם *tzom** · fast

צום צום צום



ק ק

19. Qof · k as in kite /k/

2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /k/

ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק

☐ **1** קוֹל *kol** · voice

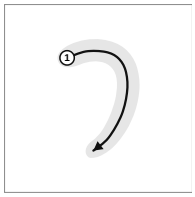
קול קול קול

☐ **2** קָפֶה *kafeh** · coffee

קפה קפה קפה

☐ **3** קָטָן *katan** · small (m)

קטן קטן קטן



ר ר

20. Resh · back-of-throat r, like French r /ʁ/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /ʁ/

ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר

☐ **1** רֹאשׁ *rosh** · head

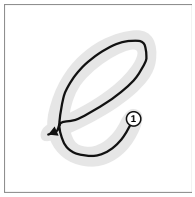
ראש ראש ראש

☐ **2** רַכֶּבֶת *rakevet** · train

רכבת רכבת רכבת

☐ **3** רֶגַע *rega* · one moment

רגע רגע רגע



ש ש

21. Shin · sh as in ship (sin, dot on the left, is s) /ʃ/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /ʃ/

ש ש ש ש ש ש ש ש ש ש ש ש

☐ **1** שָׁלוֹם *shalom* · hello / goodbye / peace

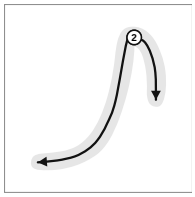
שלום שלום שלום

☐ **2** שֶׁמֶשׁ *shemesh** · sun

שמש שמש שמש

☐ **3** שְׂמֹאלָה *smola* · left

שמאלה שמאלה שמאלה



ת ת

22. Tav · t as in top /t/

2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /t/

ת ת ת ת ת ת ת ת ת ת ת ת

☐ **1** תּוֹדָה *toda* · thank you

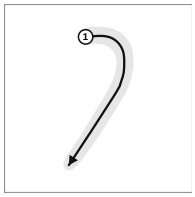
תודה תודה תודה

☐ **2** תּוֹרָה *torah** · Torah

תורה תורה תורה

☐ **3** תֵּשַׁע *tish'a* · nine (9)

תשעה תשעה תשעה



ך ך

23. Kaf sofit · same as kaf, only at the end of a word /k ~ χ/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /k ~ χ/

ך ך ך ך ך ך ך ך ך ך ך ך ך

☐ **1** מֶלֶךְ *melekh** · king

מלך מלך מלך

☐ **2** דֶּרֶךְ *derekh** · way

דרך דרך דרך

☐ **3** לַמֶּלֶךְ *lamelekh** · to the king

למלך למלך למלך



ם ם

24. Mem sofit · same as mem, only at the end of a word /m/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /m/

ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם

☐ **1** מַיִם *mayim* · water

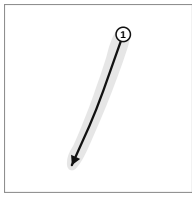
מים מים מים

☐ **2** שָׁלוֹם *shalom* · hello / goodbye / peace

שלום שלום שלום

☐ **3** לְשָׁלוֹם *leshalom** · to peace, in peace

לשלום לשלום לשלום



ן

25. Nun sofit · same as nun, only at the end of a word /n/

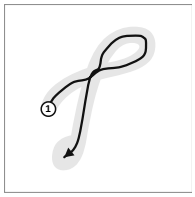
1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /n/

☐ **1** יַיִן *yayin* · wine

☐ **2** בֵּן *ben** · son

☐ **3** גַּן *gan** · garden



ף

26. Pe sofit · same as pe, only at the end of a word /p ~ f/

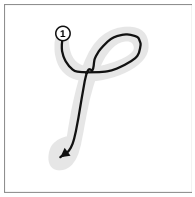
1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /p ~ f/

☐ **1** חוֹף *chof** · beach

☐ **2** אֶלֶף *elef* · one thousand (1000)

☐ **3** כֶּסֶף *kesef** · money



ץ ץ

27. Tsadi sofit · same as tsadi, only at the end of a word /ts/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /ts/

☐ **1** אֶרֶץ *eretz** · land

☐ **2** קַיִץ *kayitz** · summer

☐ **3** חָמֵץ *chametz** · leavened bread